

PETITION FOR THE CONTINUANCE OF HALVARD CINDERVALE'S LANTERN-KEEPERSHIP

To the Seat that hears petitions, whether by mercy, duty, or the
last ember of either,

We set down this plea concerning Halvard Cindervale, a minor figure
who serves as Lantern-Warden.

*Let it not be said that a minor figure is a needless figure. In
these dim years, much that is called small is the hinge upon which
the greater ruin turns. A lantern is not a crown, nor a war-banner,
nor a vault of coin. It does not command. It does not boast. It
merely gives its guarded light, provided that someone keeps it,
protects it, and refuses to abandon it when the dark presses close.*

That keeper is Halvard Cindervale.

His role is defined by the keeping and protection of a lantern. This
*is no ornament placed upon him for ceremony. His visual identity is
that of a lantern-warden, marked by a maintained lantern and the
presence of its keeper. Where the lantern is, there must be hands to
tend it. Where it is entrusted to protection, there must be
vigilance. We therefore ask that Halvard Cindervale not be
overlooked, displaced, or treated as though the work of his office
were beneath notice.*

He conveys a vigilant, dutiful atmosphere. Such qualities are easily
mocked by those who prefer noise, spectacle, and the bright promise
of sudden deliverance. Yet a *maintained lantern asks for what grand
vows do not: attention repeated without applause. Its keeper must
watch when watching is thankless. He must remain dutiful when duty
offers no glory. He must protect a light whose worth may only be
understood when all other lights have failed.*

We do not petition for a crown to be placed upon Halvard Cindervale.
We do not claim that he is more than the record permits. We ask only
that the office he serves be respected, and that the lantern in his
keeping remain protected and maintained.

Let no hand unmake what vigilance preserves. Let no careless voice
call his service empty merely because it is quiet. Let Halvard
Cindervale continue as Lantern-Warden, with the lantern before him
and the burden of its keeping upon him.

By this petition, we place his name before judgment:

Halvard Cindervale, Lantern-Warden, keeper and protector of the lantern.

May the light endure because its keeper does.